

DataExpert.io Community Academy — Week 2 Fact Data Modeling Grader Feedback

Student

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Final Grade

B

Overall Assessment

Thanks for the thorough submission. You completed all eight prompts with clear, well-linted SQL and thoughtful comments explaining grain, behavior, and edge cases. Overall, your modeling choices are sound and consistent, and your incremental patterns are correct.

Global Strengths

- Clear headers and rationale in every file; consistent casing and formatting.
- Correct grains defined and enforced with primary keys.
- Incremental logic covers carry-forward, new entities, and no-activity days.
- Good use of array operations and `GROUP BY` to prevent double-appending of the same day.
- Sensible pre-deduplication of devices to avoid join fan-out.

Global Opportunities

- **Table naming alignment:** Prompt references `nba_game_details` and `web_events`; submission uses `game_details` and `events`. Verify against the actual bootcamp schema.
- Parameterize `current_date` / `snapshot_date` for reusable, idempotent jobs.
- Consider renaming `date` to `snapshot_date` in cumulative tables.
- Consider `ON CONFLICT DO UPDATE` for cumulative inserts where reruns should be safe.

Query 1 — De-duplication

Strengths

- Correct partitioning by `(game_id, team_id, player_id)`.
- Clean expected-column selection, including quoted `"TO"`.
- Readable `ROW_NUMBER()` approach.

Improvements

- Verify `game_details` versus required `nba_game_details`.

- Add a deterministic tie-breaker when duplicate rows differ. Ordering only by partition keys can select an arbitrary duplicate.
- PostgreSQL `DISTINCT ON` could also simplify the pattern.

Query 2 — user_devices_cumulated DDL

Strengths

- Correct grain: user + browser + snapshot date.
- `DATE[]` is an appropriate activity-date representation.
- Primary key enforces the intended grain.

Improvements

- Prefer `snapshot_date` over `date`.
- Optionally prevent unexpected `NULL` activity arrays with an appropriate constraint/default.

Query 3 — user_devices_cumulated Incremental Population

Strengths

- Deduplicates devices, preventing join fan-out.
- `FULL OUTER JOIN` handles carry-forward and new combinations.
- Today is grouped to one (`user`, `browser`) row, preventing duplicate date appends.

Improvements

- Verify `events` versus `web_events`.
- Consider `ON CONFLICT` upsert behavior for idempotent reruns.

Query 4 — User Devices Activity Integer Datelist

Strengths

- Correct conceptual 32-day window.
- Correct bit direction, with current date at the highest-order bit.
- Avoiding array `UNNEST` is acceptable.

Important Functional Fix 1 — generate_series alias

The grader identified an aliasing problem. Prefer an explicit column alias:

```
CROSS JOIN LATERAL generate_series(
  DATE '2023-01-31' - INTERVAL '31 day',
```

```
DATE '2023-01-31',  
INTERVAL '1 day'  
) AS gs(valid_date)
```

Then use `gs.valid_date`.

Important Functional Fix 2 — Integer type

The requirement calls for a base-2 **integer representation**. The submitted `BIT(32)` result should instead be a `BIGINT`, for example:

```
SUM(  
CASE  
WHEN is_active  
THEN (1::BIGINT << (31 - days_since))  
ELSE 0::BIGINT  
END  
) AS datelist_int
```

Additional improvement

Parameterize the snapshot date so the 32-day calculation is reusable.

Query 5 — hosts_cumulated DDL

Strengths

- Correct grain and primary key.
- `DATE[]` fits the requirement.

Improvement

Prefer `snapshot_date` to the generic date column name.

Query 6 — hosts_cumulated Incremental

Strengths

- Correct carry-forward and new-host handling.
- Correct current-date append behavior.
- `FULL OUTER JOIN` covers expected states.

Improvements

- Verify `events` versus `web_events`.
- Consider `ON CONFLICT` handling for idempotent reruns.

Query 7 — host_activity_reduced DDL

Strengths

- Correct (month, host) grain and primary key.
- hit_array and unique_visitors use required BIGINT[].
- Array semantics are clearly documented.

Query 8 — host_activity_reduced Incremental

Strengths

- Excellent day alignment and zero-filling.
- ARRAY_FILL correctly creates leading zeros for hosts first appearing after day one.
- FULL OUTER JOIN preserves inactive-but-known hosts with zero appends.
- ON CONFLICT makes this fact-table process idempotent.
- Date parameterization is already used here.

Improvement

Verify events versus web_events.

Schema and Environment Confirmation

The grader requested confirmation of:

- nba_game_details versus game_details
- web_events versus events
- DDL/columns for the game-details, web-events, and devices sources
- Target warehouse/SQL dialect
- Intended snapshot-date and rerun policy

Verdict

All eight prompts were implemented with strong clarity and largely correct logic. The main functional issue is Query 4's aliasing/type implementation, plus possible source-table naming misalignment.

Final Grade: B

Remediation Priorities

1. Correct Query 4 generate_series aliasing.
2. Change Query 4 output from BIT(32) to BIGINT.

3. Verify/align nba_game_details versus game_details.
4. Verify/align web_events versus events.
5. Parameterize snapshot dates consistently.
6. Add explicit rerun/idempotency handling where appropriate.
7. Re-run SQL validation and preserve evidence.
8. Build and integrity-check a fresh eight-query resubmission ZIP.